



SM6P07NI Digital Media Project

20% Report

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I confirm that I understand my coursework needs to be submitted online via Google Classroom under the relevant module page before the deadline in order for my assignment to be accepted and marked. I am fully aware that late submissions will be treated as non-submission and a marks of zero will be awarded.

Abstract

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1. Introduction

1.1 Topic

The project is all about creating a Product Shoot Television Commercial (TVC) for an insulated water bottle from the MBT brand. This commercial aims to showcase the bottle's standout features, like its eco-friendly design, portability, built-in straw, and a variety of colour options. The goal is to present the product not just as a practical item, but as a stylish accessory that fits seamlessly into everyday life, whether you're going the gym, working at the office, or enjoying outdoor adventures like hiking.

The TVC will blend different visual styles, mixing high-energy, fast-paced sequences with slower, more relaxed moments to keep viewers engaged. Its length is about 50 to 60 seconds and will primarily target digital platforms like YouTube and Instagram, where eye-catching, short-form content thrives. By featuring the product in various real-life situations, the project aims to highlight its versatility and practicality while ensuring a polished and visually appealing presentation.

1.2 Area of Research

A Product Shoot TVC is all about merging together visual storytelling, technical know-how, and an insight to convey a brand's message in just a few seconds. Instead of merely showcasing a product, it combines composition, lighting, colour, movement, and sound to forge an emotional bond with the audience. This project was made thorough research into digital media production and product advertising, diving deep into how these elements combine to create captivating and convincing content. Key areas like cinematography, lighting, editing, sound design, and consumer psychology were explored, all of which shaped the creative and technical choices made during the production journey.

1.2.1 Editing Theory

Editing is crucial when it comes to making a Product Shoot TVC. It influences how visuals are showcased, how swiftly information is conveyed, and how engaging the final product feels. By using clean and intentional cuts, audience's focus can be kept on the product while ensuring a seamless visual experience.

Each editing technique has its own unique purpose. Straight cuts are often employed to maintain continuity and keep the viewer from getting distracted. Match cuts can also link similar shapes or movements across different shots, giving the commercial a polished and professional touch.

When it comes to short-form advertising, pacing becomes even more vital. Quick, well-timed edits help to keep viewers engaged, showcase key product features, and avoid any sense of repetition. Ultimately, effective editing guarantees that the message is communicated clearly and efficiently, even within a tight timeframe.

1.2.2 Sound Theory

Sound design plays a crucial role in amplifying the impact of a Product Shoot TVC, when you blend music, sound effects, it not only sets the mood but also reinforces the brand's identity.

Getting the audio mixing and mastering spot on is vital for ensuring that all sound elements harmonize beautifully. Techniques like adjusting volume levels, layering different audio tracks, and using fade-ins and fade-outs all contribute to a polished final product. For instance, a fade-in can gently introduce background music, while a fade-out can wrap up the advertisement in a seamless way.

Sound effects are equally important, as they highlight product interactions, think swoosh, pours, or movements, making the visuals feel more immersive. When done well, sound design doesn't just support the visuals; it elevates the entire viewing experience, making the commercial not only more engaging but also unforgettable.

1.2.3 Camera Theory

Camera techniques play a crucial role in how a product is viewed on screen. By using different framing, angles, and shot selections, filmmakers can steer the viewer's focus and highlight particular features of the product.

Wide shots are great for setting the scene and showing the product's surroundings. Medium shots strike a nice balance between the product and its environment, making them adaptable for various scenes. Close-up shots are especially vital in product advertising, as they bring attention to intricate details, textures, and essential features that showcase the product's quality.

Other techniques, like over-the-shoulder shots, can foster a sense of interaction or realism, while ground-level shots offer a more immersive and relatable viewpoint. Additionally, camera movements such as pans, tilts, and slow motion can elevate visual appeal and inject a dynamic energy into the commercial.

1.2.4 Lighting Theory

Lighting plays a crucial role in setting the mood, tone, and visual clarity of a Product Shoot TVC. It not only brightens the subject but also guides the viewer's focus and enhances the product's appeal.

A popular choice for lighting setups is the three-point lighting technique, which consists of a key light, fill light, and backlight. This arrangement ensures the product is well-illuminated, shadows are managed, and depth is added to distinguish the subject from the background.

In product commercials, high-key lighting is frequently employed to achieve a bright, clean, and inviting look, making the product feel more accessible. On the other hand, low-key lighting introduces stronger shadows and contrast, lending a more dramatic and upscale vibe. Ultimately, the lighting style you choose should align with the brand's identity and the emotions the advertisement seeks to evoke.

1.2.5 Emotional Influence and Consumer Engagement

Emotional appeal is a really powerful tool in advertising because it shapes how people connect with a product. Commercials that tap into feelings like happiness, comfort, or excitement are often more memorable and effective than those that just throw facts at you.

Things like music, pacing, lighting, and camera angles all play a big role in setting the emotional vibe of a TV commercial. For example, warm lighting paired with soft music can create a cozy atmosphere, while quick cuts and upbeat soundtracks can spark excitement.

By syncing these emotional signals with the brand's message, advertisers can forge deeper connections with viewers, which can really influence how they see the product and boost the chances of engagement.

1.2.6 Colour Theory and Brand Identity

Colour plays a vital role in both visual appeal and brand communication. Different colours can trigger specific psychological responses, making them a powerful tool in shaping audience perception.

In product TVCs, colour grading is used to enhance mood, improve clarity, and ensure visual consistency. Adjustments in brightness help highlight the product, while contrast adds depth and separation from the background. Proper control of highlights and shadows ensures that the product appears detailed and high-quality.

Colour schemes also contribute to brand identity. Warm tones can evoke energy and excitement, while cool tones often suggest calmness and sophistication. The balance of saturation, contrast, and brightness determines how visually impactful the commercial is, ensuring that the product stands out while maintaining a cohesive aesthetic.

1.2.7 Visual Storytelling in Product Advertising

When it comes to product commercials, there's many things at play than just the technical aspects. The most successful ads merge strong visual storytelling. Rather than just showcasing the product, effective TV commercials often demonstrate it in action or place it in familiar, everyday situations. This strategy helps viewers grasp its value and how it fits into their lives.

By blending cinematography, editing, sound, and colour, a narrative can be crafted even in a brief time frame. This storytelling technique not only makes the ad more captivating but also strengthens the brand's identity and helps the message stick with the audience.

2. Aims of Project

The aim of this project is to produce a high-quality Product Shoot Television Commercial (TVC) for the MBT water bottle that effectively showcases its key features and lifestyle benefits. The project focuses on presenting the bottle as not only a functional product but also a stylish and essential everyday accessory.

The purpose of the TVC is to promote awareness of eco-friendly and reusable products while engaging a modern, digital audience. This is achieved through the use of fast-paced editing to capture attention, combined with slow-motion shots to highlight product details such as the built-in straw and material quality. Additionally, lifestyle-based scenes such as gym use, office environments, and outdoor activities help demonstrate real-life usability, making the product more relatable to the audience. These techniques work together to fulfil the project's purpose of both informing and visually engaging viewers.

3. Target Audience

The target audience for this Product Shoot TVC mainly consists of people aged 16 to 35 who have active or laidback lifestyles. This group includes students, office workers, gym-goers, and outdoor lovers. They're likely to connect with content on digital platforms like YouTube and Instagram.

From a cultural standpoint, the audience primarily consists of urban and semi-urban folks who have more modern lifestyles, global trends, and the way we consume digital media. They're heavily influenced by social media platforms like Instagram and YouTube, where eye-catching quick content really grabs their attention. The product is crafted to be gender-neutral, appealing to both men and women equally, as its features and design cater to a wide array of tastes and daily habits. All in all, the advertisement is designed to connect with a digitally savvy crowd that appreciates both functionality and style in the products they choose.

The chosen target audience for this product is spot on, as people aged 16 to 35 are generally more engaged with digital ads and social media. This demographic tends to be more aware of sustainability and current lifestyle trends, making them perfect candidates for an eco-friendly reusable bottle.

Additionally, active folks like students, gym-goers, and outdoor lovers are likely to need a portable and sturdy water bottle in their everyday lives. By focusing on this audience, the TV commercial effectively markets the product to those who will truly appreciate its practical benefits, boosting the ad's overall impact.

4. Product Research



Figure 1: Thumbnail of Grind: This is better coffee

Video 1: **Grind: This is better coffee.**

The first reference video, “Grind: This is better coffee,” really showcased how powerful fast-paced editing and strong visual storytelling can be. The quick cuts and diverse scenes kept the audience hooked while effectively conveying the product’s essence. This inspired us to use dynamic editing techniques in our project, ensuring the advertisement stays visually captivating.

Good points:

- Clear message about what the product is about
- Has a clear CTA that it is a “better coffee”
- Scene changes to showcase it can be drunk on different scenarios

Bad Points:

- Pacing can be overwhelming for some people



Figure 2: Thumbnail of a Cinematic Water Bottle Commercial

Video 2: a Cinematic Water Bottle Commercial

The second reference, a cinematic water bottle commercial, really emphasized how crucial high-quality visuals and colour grading are. The clean composition and those detailed close-up shots did a fantastic job of highlighting the product's features. That said, the limited camera angles made the video feel a bit repetitive. With that in mind, the project aimed to incorporate a broader range of camera angles and movements—think close-ups, tracking shots, and slow-motion sequences—to make the final result more dynamic and visually captivating.

Good points:

- Has a lot of great visuals
- Colour grading is top notch

Bad points:

- The video has not been shot in other camera angles and only consists of one or two fixed camera angles.

5. Technologies Employed

Every software tool played a unique role in the production pipeline.

5.1 Davinci Resolve

DaVinci Resolve was utilized for colour correction and grading, helping to create a more visually consistent look and enhancing the overall appeal of the footage.



Figure 3: Logo of Davinci Resolve

5.2 Adobe Premiere Pro

Adobe Premiere Pro was used for editing and sequencing, to arrange clips, control the pacing, and produce the final video output.



Figure 4: Logo of Adobe Premiere Pro

5.3 Adobe After Effects

Adobe After Effects was used for creating mixed media visuals and doing motion graphics.



Figure 5: Logo of Adobe After Effects

6. Project Plan

The original plan was to do a studio-based product shoot with controlled lighting and minimal movement. But after running some test shots, it was realized that the concept didn't really connect with a lifestyle vibe and didn't showcase the product's portability as well as we hoped. Plus, the studio setup also didn't work out as intended and many shots had to be reshot which ultimately led to the concept of outdoor shoot instead.

This included outdoor settings and real-life scenarios, like gym workouts, playing football, hiking, in the office, etc. This adjustment really helped make the product more relatable and engaging for the audience.

The production timeline had to be updated accordingly to fit in the new shooting locations and any necessary reshoots. A new Gantt chart was put together to reflect these updates, making sure we stayed on top of our time management and workflow efficiency.

The original Gantt chart had a few problems, like spending way too much time on planning and not enough on actual production. The shooting was confined to a studio, which made it less realistic. Plus, the post-production tasks, such as editing and colour grading, were rushed at the end, leaving little room for finalizing. The plan also didn't allow for much flexibility since it didn't factor in time for reshoots or feedback.

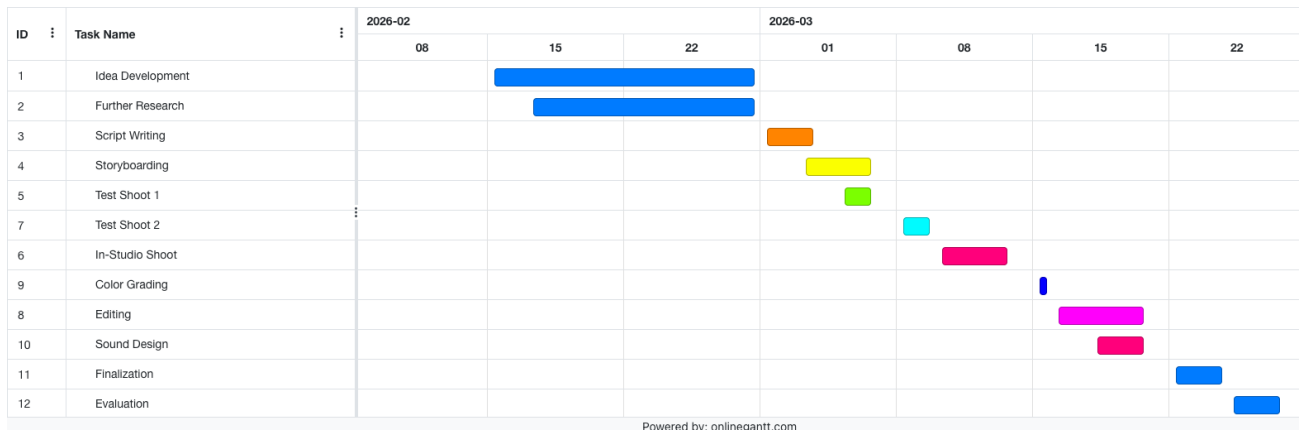


Figure 6: Old Gantt Chart

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To tackle these issues, the revamped Gantt chart brought in a more balanced and realistic workflow. It included outdoor shooting to enhance relatability, along with specific time set aside for test shoots and reshoots. Post-production was spaced out more evenly, which improved quality control, and a feedback stage was added to polish the final output. These adjustments made the whole process more efficient and led to a much stronger final product.

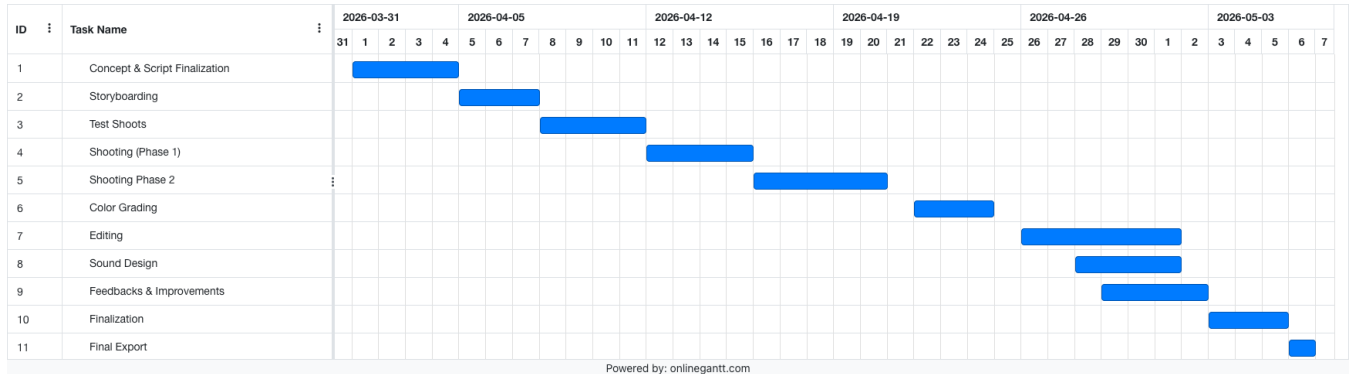


Figure 7: New Gantt Chart

7. Production Phases

7.1 Pre-production

This phase involved planning the concept, developing ideas, and creating a basic shot list. Decisions regarding locations, camera angles, and lighting setups were made during this stage and casting for the characters on the TVC were also conducted.

7.1.1 Storyboard

7.1.2 Test Shoots

7.2 Production

During the production phase, all the planned footage were captured using a mix of camera techniques. Close-up shots to really showcased the product details, while dynamic shots like tracking and handheld movements brought a dynamic energy to the visuals.

Various locations were used to film the product in real-life scenarios. This included scenes of the bottle being used during workouts, outdoor adventures, and everyday routines like in the office.

A few challenges were faced while filming. The main being lighting in outdoor settings; it was a bit unpredictable, which meant the camera settings had to be tweaked on the go. Plus, some shots needed to be redone because of framing issues and distracting background elements. Everyone involved also couldn't be always available for all the shoot timings. Other challenges were tackled with retakes and adjustments right on site.

7.3 Post-production

Since the clips were shot on a LOG profile, the clips were graded using Davinci Resolve.



Figure 8: Colour Grading in Davinci Resolve

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After all the clips were graded, the clips were exported and brought into Adobe Premiere Pro then compiled accordingly.

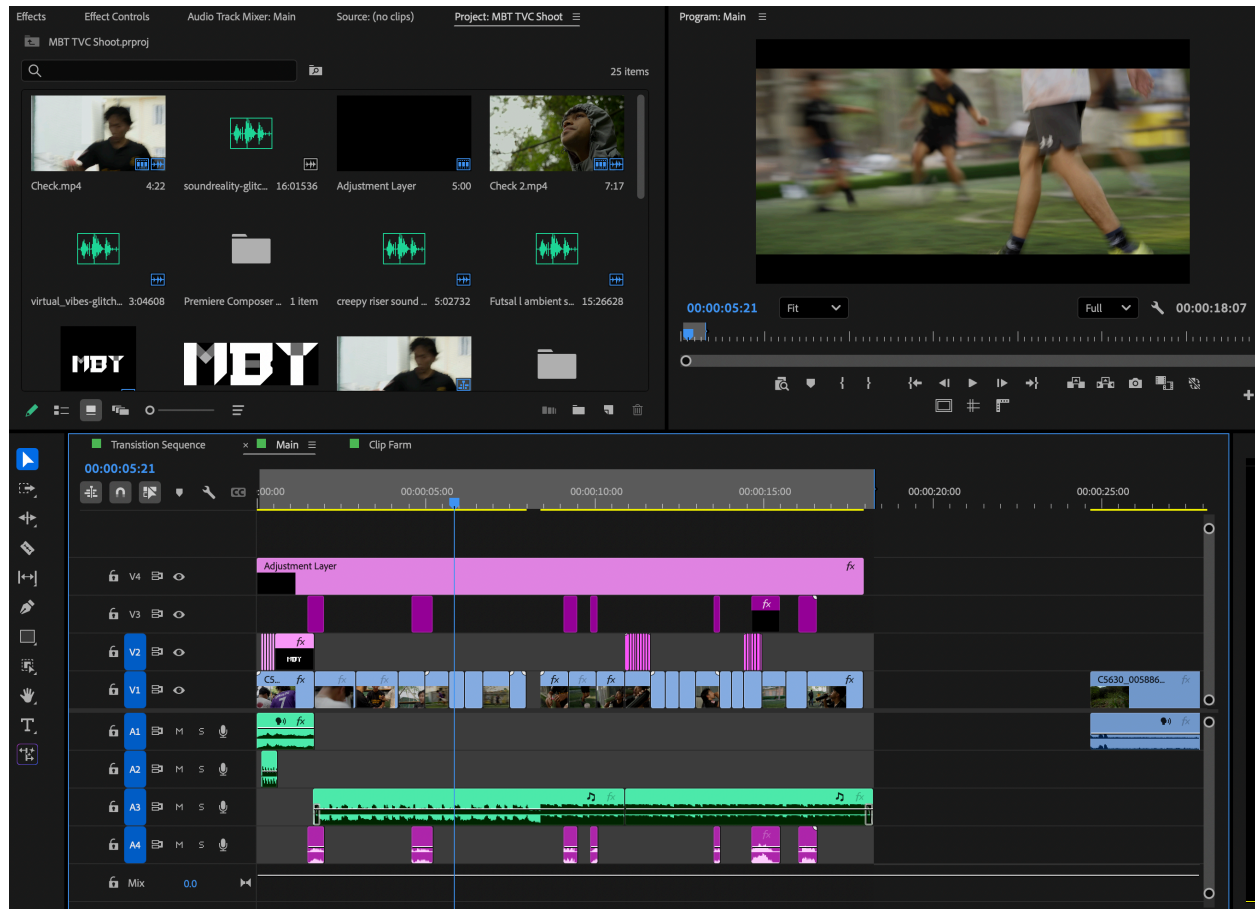


Figure 9: Editing in Adobe Premiere Pro

Feedback from peers was also considered to improve the final output.

8. Resources

The project required both hardware and software resources. Hardware included the camera, lenses, gimbal, and basic lighting equipment. Software resources included video editing tools such as Adobe Premiere Pro.

Additional resources included online research materials, reference commercials, and feedback tools such as Google Forms for evaluation. These resources supported both the production and evaluation stages of the project.

The project required a combination of both hardware and software resources to ensure a professional production workflow. For hardware, a Sony A7IV camera was used, paired with lenses like the 24–105mm, 16–35mm, and 50mm to capture a wide range of shots.

In terms of software, Adobe Premiere Pro was used as the main editing tool for assembling and refining the video. Its features allowed for cutting and compilation, and audio adjustments to enhance the overall quality of the TVC. Additional resources included online research materials and reference commercials, which helped guide the creative direction and visual style of the project. Furthermore, tools such as Google Forms were used during the evaluation phase to collect audience feedback efficiently. These combined resources supported both the production and post-production processes, contributing to the successful completion of the project.

The final TV commercial is designed for sharing on digital platforms like YouTube and Instagram, as these sites match the viewing habits of our target audience.

9. User Testing & Findings

10. Conclusion

In conclusion, this project was achieved by creating a visually appealing Product Shoot TVC for the MBT water bottle. Many things were done including all the essential elements of digital media production, from research and planning to filming, editing, and evaluation.

By using cinematography techniques, editing principles, sound design, and colour grading, the final video really highlights the product's features and the lifestyle benefits it offers. Plus, we included user testing to make sure the end result met both technical standards and audience expectations. All in all, this project showcases a solid grasp of media production processes and effective product advertising.

11. References

12. Bibliography

13. Appendix

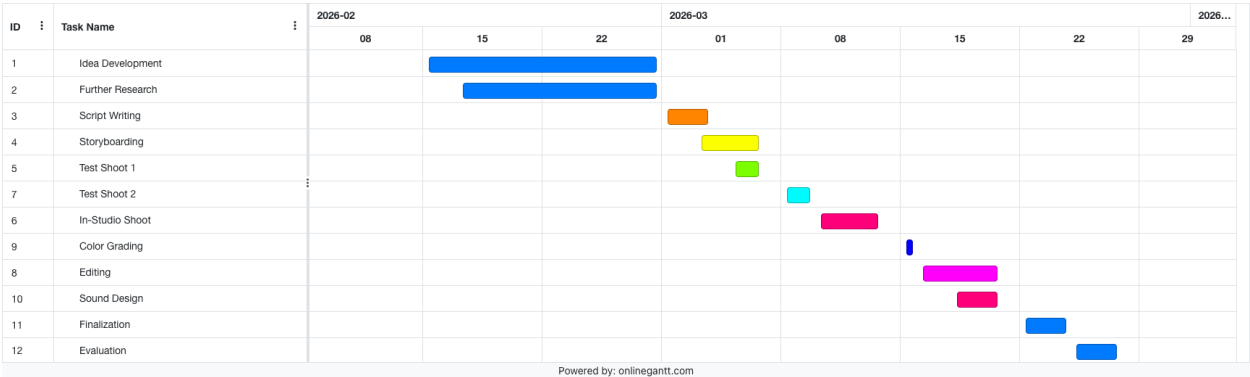


Figure 10: Old Gantt Chart

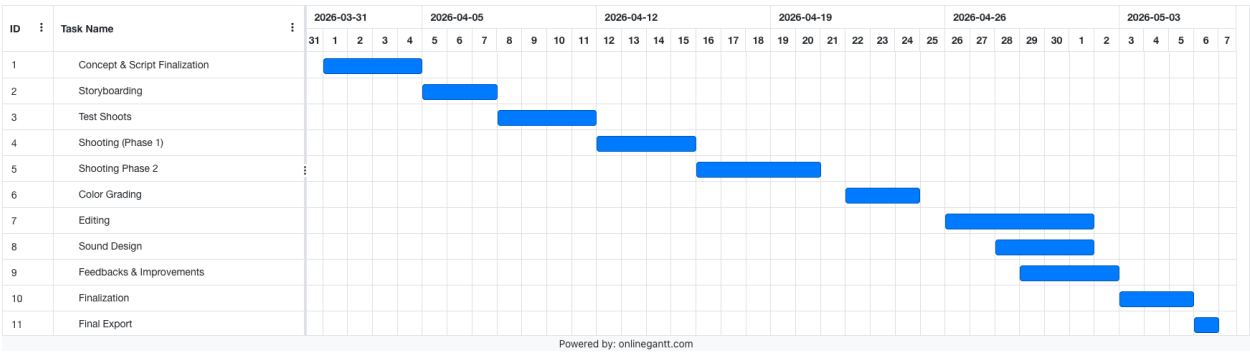


Figure 11: New Gantt Chart